

Laptops/Netbooks

When it came to buying different products from the same manufacturer, Sony won, but more laptop owners said their next laptop purchase would be a Dell

PMPs

When asked which brand people would recommend to friends and family, Sony was just a tad ahead of Apple by a fraction of a per cent

Readers of distrust

Some people were disqualified from the Readers' of Trust competition for trying to find innovative ways to vote for themselves – several hundred times

Icons of Trust

MFDs / Printers

An easier call

Last year, HP dominated this category, with Canon and Epson left fighting for second spot. This year, not surprisingly, there was no change in the top three, again. The biggest change was Wipro's fall from fourth to eighth this year, and the biggest climb was Brother – up two places to sixth.

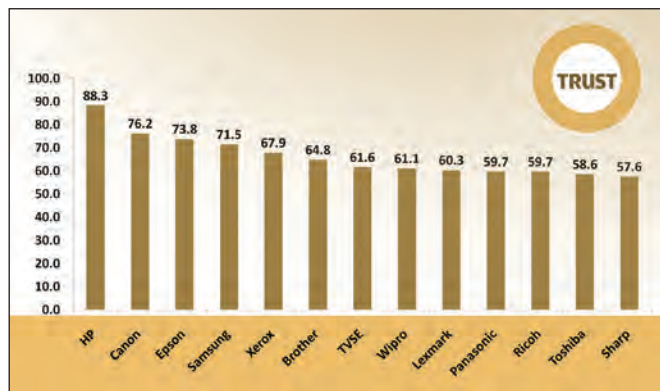
When it came to awareness, HP dominated the top of mind recall, and over 71 per cent of people had HP spring to mind when thinking of printers or MFDs. HP topped aided recall as well, with Wipro coming in second. Overall, HP was first and Epson second in the awareness field. HP actually topped in all the five parameters, so we're going to stop stating the obvious and look at the rest.

As for credibility, Canon

overtook Epson to get to second place. Canon did better than Epson in terms of quality of products, durability, improvements, listening to consumers, advanced technologies, design style, innovation and ease of use. Basically, Canon was no match for HP, but managed to beat Epson on all counts in the credibility index.

Despite losing a rank to Canon in terms of satisfaction as well, Epson did manage to upset Canon in terms of availability of products and information. Canon got its own back by having better informed sales people, after sales service, quicker resolution of queries and problems and also having more models available for purchase at stores.

Samsung was the surprise here, and managed to edge out



Because it is one of the most trusted brands, I use only HP printers. I've tried my friends printers, of other brands, and I find the printing and ink quality to be better on an HP.

Jepil Philip, Coimbatore

Epson for the third spot behind HP and Canon. Samsung was the second most popular brand, when we asked whether people would purchase other products of different categories from the brands. Samsung was also second when people were asked whether they would continue to use the same brand for some time.

Even in total cost of

ownership, Samsung came in a commendable second, ahead of Epson and Canon. Although this fight hardly seems fair, it's still good to see a lot of competition, because our Indian market certainly has the space for at least three or four big players. As of this year, our readers have spoken, and for this category, HP is the undisputed king.



PRASHANT JOSHI, 46 YEARS OLD, NAGPUR, SELLS HARDWARE AND CONDUCTS IT TRAINING

Made most recommendations in the PCs, Netbooks and Laptops categories. Twenty-five years in IT has given Prashant Joshi plenty of learning room and 1000s of people who have gone with his recommendations before making their purchase. Prashant says he is in the 'business of faith', because so many people have trusted his word before buying their computer. "We would

provide consultation before people made their purchase. In some cases we even told a potential customer that they didn't need to buy a computer. We would say 'buy that computer only if you're going to use it for at least one hour a day', he says, continuing, "This would usually surprise the customer, but then they grew to trust us because of this and this made our clients into an extended warm family, instead of just clients."

Many of his clients went on to build multi-crore businesses from the terminals he sold them. He therefore feels a sense of participation in helping build these businesses. Along the way, he says, Digit has helped him at many points. He points out the issue on netbooks in particular, which has helped convince many people to not waste money on a full-blown laptop when their requirements were just for net-based computing.



ROHAN MATTHEW, 23 YEARS OLD, KALPETTA TECHNICAL ASSOCIATE AT A RESEARCH INSTITUTE

Made most recommendations in the Assembled PCs, Monitors and External Hard disks categories. Living in rural Wyanad, Kerala can be tough for a technophile or even anyone who just wants to choose a new computer. Internet connectivity just about got there and there is only shop that sells your favourite magazine, says Rohan. He says that there is an increased need for advice in his neighbourhood and he seems to have become the local consultant for gadget-buying advice. Friends, family and people he's never met call him up regularly to make sure they make the biggest bang for their buck. He recalls how he's made the most recommendations, based on the Monitor-special issue of Digit. He's been a regular reader since 2001 and he says this has been the biggest source of his learnings. He gives advice on scanners, printers, speakers, laptops and almost everything else PC-related as he is the only person that can provide that sort of advice there.



ANISH SAWANT, 24 YEARS OLD, VASAI, MUMBAI, ENGINEERING STUDENT

Made most recommendations in the Mobile phones and Laptops categories. This young guy has a special place in the heart of a cellphone shop in the Borivali area. He's got over 40 people, among his friends and family, to buy a cell phone from that shop. He says that his subscription to Digit has been

a good guidance for his recommendations. His recommendations have spanned 10 years. Yes, that's right. Since he was 13 years old which he calls the "AIWA CD player days". It was around that time he came across a 286 PC. From there he relates how he spent hours upon hours researching the inner workings of computers and everything that surrounds it. He would then go into shops and spend even more time just talking to the

salesmen about their wares. He's never considered making money out of this hobby, especially since it's been with family and friends. "It's just the passion and interest of knowing as much as I can about this stuff that makes me the person people come to for advice. They know that they can trust me because there isn't any money involved and that's all that matters to me," he says.